

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Building A Home Network

Q I have two machines to be connected with each other, a DAX LAN card and an AdCom LAN card respectively configured. One PC has the cable LAN card with its settings. How do I connect these machines with a crossover cable and share the Net on both machines? Both computers are Celeron 2.4 GHZ with 128 MB of DDR RAM and 40GB HDDs.

Santosh Parab

A Since you have not mentioned your OS, we are assuming you are using Windows XP. The host machine, the one that will connect to the Internet, will require two LAN cards, one to connect to the Internet and the other to connect to your home network.

Make sure you are working on the computer connected directly to the Internet when doing the following:

Go to Start>Control Panel>Network and Internet Connections.

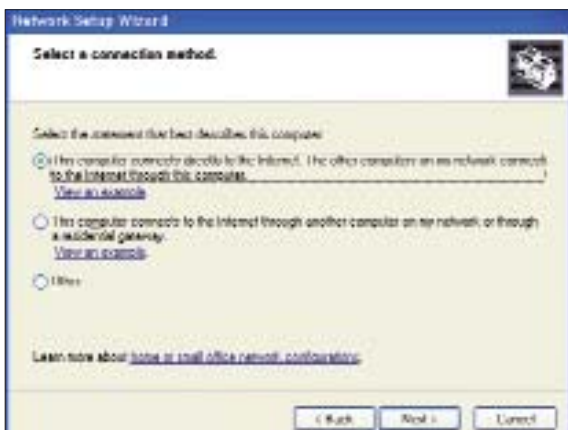
Click on "Set up or change your home or small office network."

This will open up a wizard.

Click "Next" and you will reach a screen with three options. For your host machine, click the first option, i.e. "This computer connects directly to the Internet..."

Click "Next" again, and your two LAN cards will be listed. Select the one which connects to the Internet and click "Next."

Fill in the computer description/name and other details, and click "Next". The computer



Choose your connection method—the examples should help

will then prompt you to "Click Next to save Settings" and set your Internet connection.

Repeat the process on your other machine, except, this time, choose option two, i.e. "This computer connects to the Internet through another computer..."

Follow the instructions onscreen as before, and you are ready with your home network!

Browser Hijack

Q Recently, a search bar has been installed on my computer and I cannot remove it. My homepage has been set to web-search.com and cannot be changed. If I change it, it remains there once, but the site web-search returns soon. What do I do to remove this?

Aabir Datta

A This situation is termed as a browser hijack. The easiest way to get rid of this is to download and run AdAware, provided by Lavasoft: www.snipurl.com/digitafer or Spybot Search and Destroy: www.safer-networking.org/en/spybot/index.html

You can find both Ad-Aware and Spybot on this month's Digit DVD. Look for them under "Digital Tools" and the "Security" sub-section.

You can also try using Cwshredder, from <http://snipurl.com/bgb7>.

Once the problem is fixed, ensure you upgrade to SP2 (if you are using Windows XP).

Mouse Hangs On Standby

Q I have a Pentium IV 2.6 GHz, ASUS motherboard, 256 MB of DDR RAM and an 80 GB Seagate Barracuda hard disk. The OSes are Windows 98 SE and Windows XP. The problem is that when my system goes on Standby in 98, my mouse stops responding when I try to log on again and I have to restart my PC. How do I solve this?

Amit Pure

A Microsoft has admitted to this problem in its Windows 98 OS family. This happens when Standby mode is invoked using the keyboard or a power management timer. If you use your mouse to invoke Standby, you will be able to resume properly. Alternatively, you can press [Alt] + [Tab] to bring your computer out of Standby.

In addition, you should update your keyboard, motherboard and mouse drivers. Also, make sure the power management mode you are selecting is compatible with your motherboard and/or other devices.

Messenger Mess

Q I own a P III 733 MHz with 128 MB of RAM and Windows XP Professional as the OS. Recently, my Messenger has started behaving erratically. I remember installing the latest version of Messenger after I reinstalled Windows XP and after installing Messenger 6.0, it says a